

UX / Product Designer — DragonCandy

You would improve what exists before you design anything new.

Location: Europe is fine. Working hours 12:00–18:00 Central European (06:00–12:00 US Eastern).

Engagement: Paid two-week trial → 6-month contract → extend or convert to permanent. **Start:** Target Q4 2026. You start before the developers do. **Reports to:** Dame Williams, co-founder & CTO, then the Product Manager.

The company

DragonCandy connects businesses with content creators. A restaurant gets a social media team without hiring one. A creator gets real paid partnerships instead of chasing gig apps. Our built-in AI, **Donny**, writes the campaigns, matches the right people, and schedules and publishes the posts.

The product is live at dragoncandy.com, with an iPhone app already running on a real device. We are pre-revenue by choice, with about 30 organic users.

The manifesto — this is the brief

Read this part twice. Everything else follows from it.

Our guiding rule: less typing = more margin.

Every main task should take fewer than ten keystrokes. The order of preference is: **voice, then camera, then pasting a link, then tapping a button. Typing is the last resort.** The target is a paid campaign live in under 60 seconds.

Our users are restaurant owners, not product managers. They are busy, they are not technical, and they did not want to learn software today. A screen that is elegant to a designer and confusing to a restaurant owner has failed.

Setup must feel like progress, never homework. Show someone what is possible first. Ask for what you need second. Guide them to the action third. Never ask a person to configure something before they understand why it matters.

Human-driven, AI-assisted. People make the decisions that matter. Donny does the work in between. The design should always make it obvious which is which — a user should never wonder whether a machine just committed them to something.

If you understand those four ideas, you understand the product.

What you'd own

- **The audit** — the first 30 days, described below.

- **The overall feel of the product** before any individual screen.
 - **Both screen sizes.** Here, phone and desktop are two separate design jobs, not one responsive layout. We test and ship them separately.
 - **The design system**, which already exists and which you would extend rather than replace.
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What we need

Required

- **You improve existing products.** Your first job is auditing and fixing 92 screens that already exist. A portfolio of beautiful greenfield concepts does not tell us whether you can do this.
- **You work inside an existing design system.** Ours is written down — brand colours, components, typography, layout rules. It is not perfect and you will change parts of it. But arriving wanting to replace it is the wrong instinct.
- **You design phone and desktop separately.** We are strict about this and it is unusual.
- **You care about making software feel simple for people who are not technical.** This is the actual job.
- **Figma.**
- **Comfortable with AI tools** — we use Claude across the company.

Bonus

- Marketplace or two-sided platform work
 - Design for small business owners, hospitality, or the creator economy
 - Enough front-end familiarity to read a component and know what is cheap to change
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The first 90 days

Weeks 1–2 — paid trial. Audit a defined slice of the product and show us what you found and what you would do. Paid at full rate.

Days 1–30 — the audit, alongside the product manager. Go through every surface, on **both** screen sizes, for all three user types. Assess it for usability and for consistency against the existing design system. Write down what is confusing, what is inconsistent, and what is simply unfinished.

Start with the overall direction, then move to specific screens. We want the holistic view first — this was an explicit request from our board.

Your findings go into the same prioritised backlog as the product manager's.

Days 30–90. The developers arrive and start fixing what the audit found. You design the fixes, review what ships, and start on the screens that need genuine redesign rather than repair.

How we work

- **Two-week cycles.** Monday planning, Friday demo.
 - **Linear** for tickets, synced with GitHub. Every ticket names the user type and the screen size.
 - **Written and asynchronous by default.** About three hours of live overlap with the US daily.
 - **Done means done:** shipped, checked on phone and desktop, verified live.
 - Designs go to developers as Figma plus a written description of the behaviour — including what happens while it is loading and when it goes wrong. Those two states are where most of our product's rough edges are.
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Why take this job

92 screens, real users, a design system to build on, and an explicit mandate to make it simpler rather than bigger. You would be our first designer, so the visual identity of the product from here is yours.

The honest risks: pre-revenue, no launch date, and a product built by an engineer, which means some of what you find will be rough. That is why the role exists.

Applying

Send a portfolio, and pick one product you did not design that you think is badly designed — tell us what you would change and why. Include your rate expectation in the first message.